

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 6 2

♥ 6 5 3

♦ 9 7 2

♣ 5 4 3

♠ A T 8

♥ K Q 4

♦ A K T

♣ A 9 8 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 7 4

♥ A J T

♦ Q J 4

♣ Q J T 7

♠ 9 5 3

♥ 9 8 7 2

♦ 8 6 5 3

♣ K 6

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

6NT

All Pass

6NT by North

(nothing) denied that Queen.

[showcards S:H4 W:H9]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♥9, taken by dummy's ♥10. The ♠4 is then played from dummy. Do you play low? or split your honors?

Play the ♠J (or ♠Q).

You should always make a point count check as soon as you see dummy. North's 2NT promises 20 or 21 points, South has 14 and you have 3; total = 37 or 38. Therefore East must have either 2 or 3 points. He cannot have two Jacks because you can see all four of them. Likewise he cannot have a Queen because you can see three of them and his ♥ lead (top of

It follows that East **MUST** have a King, and it must be ♣s or ♦s since he has denied any ♥ Honor.

Since East will definitely win his King, you need to take one trick yourself, and the best way to do that is to split your Honors to establish one ♠ winner.

North has no defense to this, but if you had played low he would have played the ♠T and made the slam.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 5
 ♥ Q 7 4
 ♦ T 7 2
 ♣ A J 9 5

♠ 7 6 3

♥ K J T

♦ K J 9 6

♣ T 7 2



♠ A Q 4

♥ A 8 5

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ 8 6 3

♠ T 9 8 2

♥ 9 6 3 2

♦ 5 3

♣ K Q 4

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

If you play low, he **MIGHT** finesse the ♣J and again establish 3 ♣ winners. But East's correct play would be to put on dummy's ♣9, finessing South for the ♣T. This is because ♣ K 10 **or** ♣ Q 10 are twice as likely as ♣ K Q.

If he does play this way North will win the ♣T and your ♣ K Q will get one more trick.

[showcards W:ST E:S3 S:SA,C3]

You are South. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♠T; low cards from West and North, won by East with the ♠A.

East next plays the ♣3 and you must decide whether to split your ♣ K Q.

Play the ♣4.

If you split your Honors, playing the ♣Q perhaps, dummy's ♣A will take the trick and East will later play through your ♣K toward dummy's ♣ J 9 5. Played in this way he will establish 3 ♣ winners (which he needs for the contract).

Board 3

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8 7 3

♥ T

♦ J T 9 8 5 2

♣ Q 5

♠ A K 9 4

♥ K Q 6

♦ A Q 4

♣ T 8 6



♠ T 6 2

♥ 7 3

♦ K 7 6 3

♣ A 9 4 2

♠ Q 5

♥ A J 9 8 5 4 2

♦ -

♣ K J 7 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♣

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

2NT

Pass

6 ♥

All Pass

6 ♥ by South

with 2 ♠s, 7 ♥s, and no ♦s. His other 4 cards must have been ♣s, and he has discarded 2 of them.

So he has 2 ♣s left in his hand. If one of them is the ♣K and you play your ♣A then you have handed him the contract.

By playing low you give him a guess to make. If he plays the ♣K he will make the contract, but if he plays the ♣J he will go down. He will probably play the ♣J, figuring you wouldn't have the nerve to duck with the ♣A. He'll know better next time he plays against you.

[showcards W:DJ]

You are East. The bidding has been as shown, (wild).

Partner led the ♦J; ♦Q from dummy, ♦K from you and ruffed by South.

South then pulls two rounds of trumps, (West discards on the second one), followed by his ♠Q, dummy's ♠A K and dummy's ♦A. South discards ♣s on the last two cards.

The ♣6 is then played from dummy and you must make a decision - ♣A or ♣2?

Play the ♣2.

You have a full count on South's hand. He started

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 9 5
♥ 9 3
♦ A K Q
♣ K 9 7 5 2

♠ K Q 4

♥ 7 4

♦ J 9 7 5 4

♣ A J 3



♠ 8 6 2

♥ A K Q J T

♦ 8 3

♣ Q T 6

♠ A T 7 3

♥ 8 6 5 2

♦ T 6 2

♣ 8 4

West	North	East	South
1♣	Pass	1♥	Pass
1NT	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			

3NT by West

Next ask yourself "Where is the ♠A?" Clearly South **DOES** have this card; otherwise West has his 9 tricks.

So the way to beat the contract is to go up with your ♣A, then play ♠K, ♠Q and a third ♠, hoping South holds ♠A x x x.

[showcards W:D5 S:DK,C9]

You are North. The bidding has been as shown.

You lead the ♦5; ♦3, ♦10 and won by West with ♦K. West now leads the ♣9 from his hand

Play the ♣A.

First ask yourself "Where are the ♦A and ♦Q?" South doesn't have either one or he would have played it at the first trick. So West has both of them. So with those 3 tricks and the 5 ♥s in dummy West only needs to find one more winner. Assuming he has the ♣K, (or why play the suit), if you play low he will find that one more winner whichever high ♣ he plays.